

Men's Ballon d'Or

France Football created the Ballon d'Or in 1956. Eligibility rules changed over time: the award was initially limited to European players, opened to players of any nationality at European clubs in 1995, and became fully global in 2007. From 2010 through 2015 it was presented jointly with FIFA.

Men's Ballon d'Or winners, 1956 to present

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
2025	Ousmane Dembélé	France	22 September 2025
2024	Rodri	Spain	28 October 2024
2023	Lionel Messi	Argentina	30 October 2023
2022	Karim Benzema	France	17 October 2022
2021	Lionel Messi	Argentina	29 November 2021
2020	Not awarded	—	—
2019	Lionel Messi	Argentina	2 December 2019
2018	Luka Modrić	Croatia	3 December 2018
2017	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	7 December 2017

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
2016	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	12 December 2016
2015	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	11 January 2016
2014	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	12 January 2015
2013	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	13 January 2014
2012	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	7 January 2013
2011	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	9 January 2012
2010	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	10 January 2011
2009	<u>Lionel Messi</u>	Argentina	1 December 2009
2008	<u>Cristiano Ronaldo</u>	Portugal	2 December 2008
2007	<u>Kaká</u>	Brazil	2 December 2007
2006	<u>Fabio Cannavaro</u>	Italy	27 November 2006
2005	<u>Ronaldinho</u>	Brazil	28 November 2005
2004	<u>Andriy Shevchenko</u>	Ukraine	13 December 2004
2003	<u>Pavel Nedvěd</u>	Czech Republic	22 December 2003
2002	<u>Ronaldo</u>	Brazil	12 December 2002
2001	<u>Michael Owen</u>	England	18 December 2001

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
2000	<u>Luís Figo</u>	Portugal	19 December 2000
1999	<u>Rivaldo</u>	Brazil	21 December 1999
1998	<u>Zinedine Zidane</u>	France	22 December 1998
1997	<u>Ronaldo</u>	Brazil	23 December 1997
1996	<u>Matthias Sammer</u>	Germany	24 December 1996
1995	<u>George Weah</u>	Liberia	26 December 1995
1994	<u>Hristo Stoichkov</u>	Bulgaria	20 December 1994
1993	<u>Roberto Baggio</u>	Italy	28 December 1993
1992	<u>Marco van Basten</u>	Netherlands	22 December 1992
1991	<u>Jean-Pierre Papin</u>	France	24 December 1991
1990	<u>Lothar Matthäus</u>	West Germany	25 December 1990
1989	<u>Marco van Basten</u>	Netherlands	26 December 1989
1988	<u>Marco van Basten</u>	Netherlands	27 December 1988
1987	<u>Ruud Gullit</u>	Netherlands	29 December 1987
1986	<u>Igor Belanov</u>	Soviet Union	30 December 1986
1985	<u>Michel Platini</u>	France	24 December 1985

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
1984	<u>Michel Platini</u>	France	25 December 1984
1983	<u>Michel Platini</u>	France	27 December 1983
1982	<u>Paolo Rossi</u>	Italy	28 December 1982
1981	<u>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</u>	West Germany	29 December 1981
1980	<u>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</u>	West Germany	30 December 1980
1979	<u>Kevin Keegan</u>	England	25 December 1979
1978	<u>Kevin Keegan</u>	England	27 December 1978
1977	<u>Allan Simonsen</u>	Denmark	27 December 1977
1976	<u>Franz Beckenbauer</u>	West Germany	28 December 1976
1975	<u>Oleg Blokhin</u>	Soviet Union	30 December 1975
1974	<u>Johan Cruyff</u>	Netherlands	31 December 1974
1973	<u>Johan Cruyff</u>	Netherlands	25 December 1973
1972	<u>Franz Beckenbauer</u>	West Germany	26 December 1972
1971	<u>Johan Cruyff</u>	Netherlands	28 December 1971
1970	<u>Gerd Müller</u>	West Germany	29 December 1970
1969	<u>Gianni Rivera</u>	Italy	23 December 1969

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
1968	<u>George Best</u>	Northern Ireland	24 December 1968
1967	<u>Flórián Albert</u>	Hungary	26 December 1967
1966	<u>Bobby Charlton</u>	England	27 December 1966
1965	<u>Eusébio</u>	Portugal	28 December 1965
1964	<u>Denis Law</u>	Scotland	22 December 1964
1963	<u>Lev Yashin</u>	Soviet Union	17 December 1963
1962	<u>Josef Masopust</u>	Czechoslovakia	18 December 1962
1961	<u>Omar Sívori</u>	Italy	12 December 1961
1960	<u>Luis Suárez</u>	Spain	13 December 1960
1959	<u>Alfredo Di Stéfano</u>	Spain	15 December 1959
1958	<u>Raymond Kopa</u>	France	16 December 1958
1957	<u>Alfredo Di Stéfano</u>	Spain	17 December 1957
1956	<u>Stanley Matthews</u>	England	18 December 1956

Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Lionel Messi 	8
2009, 2010, 2011, 2012, 2015, 2019, 2021, 2023	
Cristiano Ronaldo 	5
2008, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017	
Johan Cruyff 	3
1971, 1973, 1974	
Michel Platini 	3
1983, 1984, 1985	
Marco van Basten 	3
1988, 1989, 1992	
Alfredo Di Stéfano 	2
1957, 1959	
Franz Beckenbauer 	2
1972, 1976	
Kevin Keegan 	2
1978, 1979	
Karl-Heinz Rummenigge 	2
1980, 1981	

Ronaldo  1997, 2002	2
Stanley Matthews  1956	1
Raymond Kopa  1958	1
Luis Suárez  1960	1
Omar Sívori  1961	1
Josef Masopust  1962	1
Lev Yashin  1963	1
Denis Law  1964	1
Eusébio  1965	1

Bobby Charlton  1966	1
Flórián Albert  1967	1
George Best  1968	1
Gianni Rivera  1969	1
Gerd Müller  1970	1
Oleg Blokhin  1975	1
Allan Simonsen  1977	1
Paolo Rossi  1982	1
Igor Belanov  1986	1

Ruud Gullit  1987	1
Lothar Matthäus  1990	1
Jean-Pierre Papin  1991	1
Roberto Baggio  1993	1
Hristo Stoichkov  1994	1
George Weah  1995	1
Matthias Sammer  1996	1
Zinedine Zidane  1998	1
Rivaldo  1999	1

Luís Figo  2000	1
Michael Owen  2001	1
Pavel Nedvěd  2003	1
Andriy Shevchenko  2004	1
Ronaldinho  2005	1
Fabio Cannavaro  2006	1
Kaká  2007	1
Luka Modrić  2018	1
Karim Benzema  2022	1

Rodri

1

2024

Ousmane Dembélé

1

2025

How it works

- The Ballon d'Or honors the best individual men's player of the year - it is not a team competition or a national-team trophy.
- A panel of football journalists, one from each eligible country, ranks their top players; the votes are combined into one final ranking.
- Eligibility has widened over time: Europe-only at first, then any nationality at a European club from 1995, then fully global since 2007 (see the introduction above).
- The winner is announced at an end-of-year ceremony organized by France Football magazine.

Notes

- Lev Yashin remains the only goalkeeper to win the men's award.
- George Weah became the first African winner in 1995.
- Luka Modrić won in 2018.
- The 2020 award was cancelled.
- Ousmane Dembélé won the 2025 award.

References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 14 August 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>).
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html>)

- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-dece-mbre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.voanews.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.